

Five common agent designs, and the failure each leaves open

Direct loop

WHAT IT DOES

One model works and decides it is done.

WHAT CAN STILL GO WRONG

A confident wrong answer can pass.

Fixed workflow

A preset graph routes work through model steps.

A new situation can have no valid route.

Model team

Models plan, work, debate, and vote.

Shared blind spots can win the vote.

Search or evolution

Many candidates are scored and selected.

A model-written score can reward the wrong thing.

Memory add-on

Past notes are retrieved into later prompts.

A wrong note can become a lasting fact.

Shared problem: the model can still approve, preserve, or spread its own mistake.